

Flower Dedication

The flowers that adorn the sanctuary today are given in celebration of their 55th wedding anniversary by Dr. Bo & Lou Perry.

Announcements

Church Fellowship Night — Tonight! Meet in the Sanctuary at 5:30 p.m. for Family Worship, followed by a Church Potluck Dinner in the Fellowship Hall. Chicken tenders will be provided — please bring your favorite dish, side, or dessert. Nursery available for children up to 3.

Women’s Bible Study Begins This Week! *“What’s She Doing Here? The Messy Women in Jesus’ Genealogy”* by Susan Tyner. Two times to attend this 9-week study: Tuesday mornings, 8:00–9:00 a.m. in the Conference Room, facilitated by Laura Kate Carmichiel, begins August 18; or Wednesday evenings, 6–7 p.m. in the Conference Room, facilitated by Jennifer LeGoff, begins August 19. Please register for either study by texting or emailing Laura Kate: 662-808-5056 or lkarmichiel@fpccorinth.org.

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Dr. Mark Mazurkiewicz
Greeters — Dr. John & Jennifer Shipp
Acolytes — Reid Butler & Jack Windsor
Circle of Prayer — Dr. Stephen & Cindy Blair

Ushers — Trey Tull, Don Williams, Brent Johnson, Hack Smith, & Hayden Worsham
Nursery — Deborah Kiddy, Sarah Bynum, Jennifer Sexton, Deb Parker, Laura Giaccaglini, & Mary Elizabeth Pounders
AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor
Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship
Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care
Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries
Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.

Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director
Jan Pike - Choir Director
Malachi Doren - Accompanist
Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant
Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

August 16 Deacons’ Meeting · Church Fellowship Night, 5:30 p.m.
August 19 KidsQuest / Youth

August 20 MI3 Week 2
August 22 Back-to-School Youth Retreat

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

August 16, 2026

Twelfth Sunday after Pentecost

“To be disciples, to make disciples”

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children (age 4+) and their families worship together in the sanctuary, where children will be dismissed to Children’s Church during the service. Children’s bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Children are always welcome in worship!

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

“Restored by Grace: Finished by Grace”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 6:13–22

For sixteen years, the temple stood unfinished. To the people, it probably looked as though God’s promises had stalled. However, while they saw delay, God was accomplishing His purposes. The temple was not unfinished because God had forgotten His people. It was unfinished because God was still writing the story. When His time was right, He completed exactly what He had promised. That is the story of the gospel. Ultimately, it is the story of every disciple. The God who begins His work is the God who finishes it.

As we come to Ezra 6 this morning, we will discover that God doesn’t simply complete a building. He completes His gracious purposes so that His redeemed people might once again worship Him with joy. We are going to examine how this happens.

I. God Faithfully Completes His Work (vv. 13–15)

II. God Restores His People to Joyful Worship (vv. 16–18)

“The acceptable way of worshiping the true God is instituted by Himself...” (Westminster Confession of Faith 21.1)

III. God Restores Joyful Communion (vv. 19–22)

1 Corinthians 5:7–8 — “Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed. Let us therefore celebrate the festival...with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.”

TABLE	
THE LORD’S SUPPER The Lord’s Supper is a means of grace in which Christ spiritually nourishes believers, strengthening their faith as they partake of the bread and cup in union with Him. The sacrament is a tangible, concrete gift where we can physically remember the goodness of the gospel story.	The Sacrament of the Lord’s Supper Invitation to the Table
PRAYER OF CONFESSION Our worship moves from adoration to grace, to confession, then assurance, and finally to the Table. This prayer intentionally acknowledges our tendency toward self-reliance while anticipating the grace that Christ offers in the Sacrament.	Corporate Prayer of Confession <i>Faithful Father, You have never failed to keep Your promises, yet we confess that we often forget Your grace. Too often our worship grows routine, our hearts grow cold, and we trust our own strength instead of Your faithful provision. Forgive us for our distracted hearts, our joyless obedience, and our failure to remember Your mighty works. By Your Holy Spirit, renew us and restore to us the joy of Your salvation so that we may worship You with gladness and serve You faithfully with sincere hearts. Through Jesus Christ our Lord.</i> <i>Silent Confession</i> Assurance of Pardon: Psalm 103:11–12 “For as high as the heavens are above the earth, so great is his steadfast love toward those who fear him; as far as the east is from the west, so far does he remove our transgressions from us.” The Words of Institution: 1 Corinthians 11:23–29 Partaking of the Elements Prayer of Thanksgiving
SENDING	
BENEDICTION God’s people are blessed by the Lord and sent forth into the world, bearing with them the hope and peace of the Gospel. As we continue our worship, we do so as people sent to our community for reconciliation, bearing witness to the good news of the gospel.	*Hymn of Commitment: #1 <i>“Joyful, Joyful, We Adore Thee”</i> *Benediction *Postlude

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD	
August 16, 2026	
<i>* Indicates congregation standing if able</i>	
GATHERING	
The Piano Prelude	
Greetings & Announcements	
Call to Meditation: Philippians 1:6 “And I am sure of this, that he who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ.”	
The Prelude	PRELUDE The prelude provides a quiet moment to prepare for worship. As the music begins, we are encouraged to calm our hearts, focus our minds, and enter reverently into God’s presence.
Choral Introit	<i>“Blessed Assurance”</i>
*Scriptural Call to Worship: Psalm 100 Leader: Make a joyful noise to the Lord, all the earth! Serve the Lord with gladness! Come into his presence with singing! Know that the Lord, he is God! <i>All: It is he who made us, and we are his; we are his people, and the sheep of his pasture.</i> Leader: Enter his gates with thanksgiving, and his courts with praise! Give thanks to him; bless his Name! <i>All: For the Lord is good; his steadfast love endures forever, and his faithfulness to all generations.</i>	CALL TO WORSHIP We are summoned to worship by God’s word, calling His people into His presence to honor Him in spirit and truth, opening a sacred conversation that unfolds throughout the service. We sing in response to God’s call to worship, which is a reminder that worship is at God’s initiative, not ours.
*The Hymn: #66	<i>“To God Be the Glory”</i>

*Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

*The Old Testament Reading: Exodus 12:21–27

Then Moses called all the elders of Israel and said to them, “Go and select lambs for yourselves according to your clans, and kill the Passover lamb. Take a bunch of hyssop and dip it in the blood that is in the basin, and touch the lintel and the two doorposts with the blood that is in the basin. None of you shall go out of the door of his house until the morning. For the Lord will pass through to strike the Egyptians, and when he sees the blood on the lintel and on the two doorposts, the Lord will pass over the door and will not allow the destroyer to enter your houses to strike you. You shall observe this rite as a statute for you and for your sons forever. And when you come to the land that the Lord will give you, as he has promised, you shall keep this service. And when your children say to you, ‘What do you mean by this service?’ you shall say, ‘It is the sacrifice of the Lord’s Passover, for he passed over the houses of the people of Israel in Egypt, when he struck the Egyptians but spared our houses.’” And the people bowed their heads and worshiped.

*Congregational Response: #208

“Alas, and Did My Savior Bleed?” (vv. 1–3)

ALAS! AND DID MY SAVIOR BLEED?
Echoing the deep awareness of our unworthiness before a holy God, this hymn leads us from the sorrow of the cross to the joy of God’s redeeming love. As the returned exiles in Ezra 6 rejoiced when the Lord completed His work of restoration, so we rejoice that Christ has finished the work of our redemption, calling us to grateful and joyful praise.

*The New Testament Reading: 1 Corinthians 5:6–8

Your boasting is not good. Do you not know that a little leaven leavens the whole lump? Cleanse out the old leaven that you may be a new lump, as you really are unleavened. For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed. Let us therefore celebrate the festival, not with the old leaven, the leaven of malice and evil, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.

A Moment for Missions

*Bubba & Kelli Harrell, David & Laura Nelson
Roca Blanca Mission Base, Mexico*

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

The Offertory

*The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication

Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

*Children Dismissed to Children’s Church

CHILDREN’S CHURCH
Children ages 4 up to 4th grade are invited to come forward and exit out the side door for Children’s Church. Following the worship service, they may be picked up in the Fellowship Hall.

WORD

Scripture Reading

Ezra 6:13–22 · Pew Bible, p. 393

Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8

Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;
All: The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever. Amen.

Sermon: “Restored by Grace: Finished by Grace”

Rev. Waring Porter

Prayer of Commitment

Choral Anthem

*“At Your Table, Lord”
May P. Hoyt, William F. Sherman; arr. Keith Christopher*